

MINUTES
VANCE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
WORK SESSION
October 20, 2025

The Vance County Board of Commissioners held a work session on Monday, October 20, 2025, at 4:00 p.m. in the Commissioners' Conference Room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. The commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, and Leo Kelly, Jr.

Absent: Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster, Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. and Commissioner Valencia Perry.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, and Clerk to the Board Dywanda Pettaway. County Attorney Jonathan S. Care was absent.

Rezoning Case ZMA25-002. Ms. Sherry Moss represented to the board the Rezoning Case ZMA25-002 for additional clarifying questions. It was stated that this is the rezoning request for the R30 to R20 (changing from a 30,000 sq ft lot size to a 20,000 sq ft lot size) from Mrs. Patricia Hughes, who is the owner of 158 West, LLC. of Fuller Lane located off Hwy 158 Business. Following the presentation and discussion, there was no action needed to be taken by the board, and it will be brought back to the board for consideration of approval at November's meeting.

DSS Telework – Pilot Department. Ms. Cassandra Hart, Director of the Department of Social Services, presented information to the Board regarding a proposed telework schedule for departmental employees. The presentation included a study of surrounding counties demonstrating the potential benefits of implementing telework within the Social Services and Child Welfare divisions.

Ms. Hart explained that all teleworking activity would be monitored through the NC FAST system, which tracks user activity and time logged into the system. Eligibility for telework will require the ability to work independently; therefore, new employees will be required to complete a three-month in-office training period prior to being considered for telework eligibility.

Ms. Hart also noted that the Child Welfare Division will implement a similar monitoring system, PATH NC, beginning November 3, 2025, to track all related activities.

Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt and Charisse Fain inquired about system security measures. Ms. Hart responded that security details would be coordinated with the Information Technology Department. It was further mentioned by Ms. Renee Perry that Mr. Randall Medlin had previously requested additional funds in October to enhance network security. Please keep in mind that all teleworking employees remain connected to the County's secure network while signed in remotely. Following discussion, no action was needed to be taken at this time. It will be brought back before the Board for further consideration and possible approval at a later date.

Fiscal Operations Policy. Ms. Renee Perry presented to the board the revised Fiscal Operations Policy for review and consideration. This update is meant to strengthen our financial management framework and make sure we're aligned with current best practices. I'd ask that we focus on broader policy direction and intent -things like transparency, accountability, and consistency-rather than getting too deep into the day-to-day operational, spelling errors, etc. Those concerns and procedures will be handled at the staff I would like Board of Commissioners feedback by Monday, October 27, 2025, at 5pm. We would like to get this approved at the November meeting. The County has never adopted a comprehensive financial policy and considering the activities over the past several years, it is crucial that we put this policy in place to hold everyone accountable.

No Wake Zone. Ms. Renee Perry presented to the board information on a no wake zone for review and consideration. In North Carolina, no-wake zones are governed entirely by the North Carolina Wildlife Resources Commission (NCWRC) under G.S. 75A-15. A no-wake zone is an area where boaters must operate at idle speed-just fast enough to maintain steering-so their boat produces no appreciable wake that could damage property, erode shorelines, or endanger swimmers and other vessels. The Board of County Commissioners cannot directly create or enforce these zones under county ordinance. Instead, the Board must:

1. Adopt a resolution requesting that the NC Wildlife Resources Commission establish a no-wake zone in specified waters; and
2. Submit that resolution to the NCWRC for review and possible rule adoption.

Once approved by NCWRC, the area becomes a formally designated zone under state law (recorded in the North Carolina Administrative Code).

Afterward:

- The County may help install and maintain official "No Wake" buoys or signs (under NCWRC supervision).
- Enforcement is handled by NCWRC law enforcement officers, not county staff or deputies unless specifically authorized through cross-deputation.
- Any additional requests from the public for new areas can be reviewed internally and referred to NCWRC under this standing resolution.

By adopting a countywide resolution covering all maneuverable waters within Vance County, the Board demonstrates proactive commitment to public safety while preserving the correct legal process. This allows the County to efficiently respond to future citizen complaints or incidents by simply submitting follow-up documentation to NCWRC without needing new Board action each time.

Letter of Support for Location of Detention Facility. Ms. Perry presented to the board information about a letter of support for the proposed location of the Vance County detention facility for review and consideration. Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. has been working with the state on the piece of property that is located beside the Vance County animal shelter. It is about 10 acres, with a well and septic tank already on the land. So, Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., is working to acquire this land at no cost to the county, but nothing has been settled. However, the state is asking that the commissioners submit a letter of support showing that we are in support of the detention center being situated on that piece of land. The Sheriff has already submitted a letter stating his support. So, I am asking for your consensus to submit a letter of support on your behalf.

All was in support of Ms. Perry submitting the letter to Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. to submit to the state on our behalf.

As there was no further business, at 4:50 p.m., a motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain to adjourn the meeting. The vote was unanimous and the meeting adjourned.

Approved: November 3, 2025

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair